

Figure 2.2: Example of a boom barrier



Source: *Portable Traffic Control Devices, 2017, Queensland Department of Transport and Main Roads*

Location

The key considerations in determining a safe location for traffic controllers include site geometry, traffic control device position, sight distance, roadside terrain/vegetation, the type of PTC used, vehicle mix and their approach speeds. Environmental factors (for example fog, rain, dust or smoke) and time of day/night also need to be considered.

Traffic controllers should occupy a position which:

- is clear of the travel path (the risk of being struck by passing vehicles is significantly reduced as the offset distance is increased)
- has an escape path
- has sight distance of approaching traffic
- aims to ensure that drivers focus on the device, and not take cues from the traffic controllers
- enables effective communication to both site workers and other traffic controllers (if applicable). If a single traffic controller is operating two PTCs, an added consideration is required to ensure the operating range of the hand-held remote controller is not exceeded
- enables the traffic controller to identify the last vehicle before changing to STOP
- is close enough to the PTC to allow the traffic controller to commence STOP/SLOW but duties in the event of a system failure. In the case of a single traffic controller operating two PTCs, the traffic controller should be located at the end which is on approach to the closed section of road (as this is the critical approach to control in the event of a failure)
- has visibility of the PTC (either the front face or rear indicator light) and traffic queues. In the case of a single traffic controller operating two PTCs, the traffic controller should be located to have visibility of both devices and traffic queues for each approach.